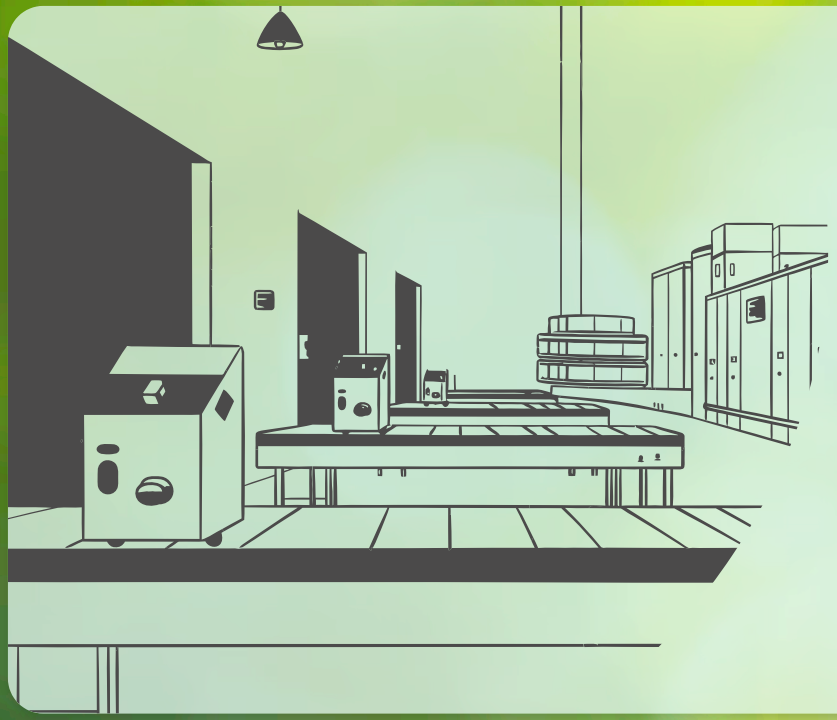


ENT307 — Marketing of Services

Summer Term | IIIT Delhi · Instructor: **Prof. Alok Srivastava**

How many services have you already used before entering this classroom today?

Alarm

Maps

UPI

WhatsApp

Metro

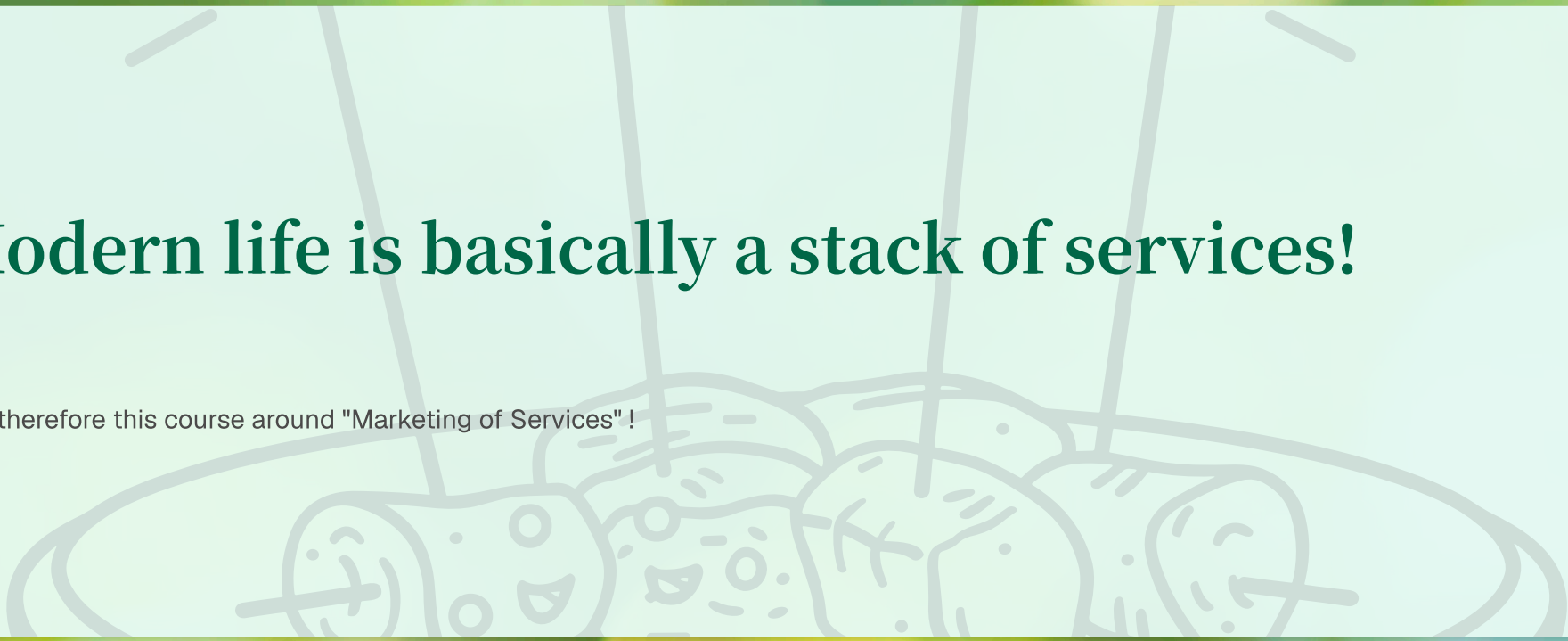
Spotify

Gmail

Food Delivery

Modern life is basically a stack of services!

And therefore this course around "Marketing of Services" !





About Me

My Name is Alok Srivastava (Btw I am not a Dr)

I am a professional leader with over **17 years of experience in strategic management and product running businesses at the leadership level.** I have held top management positions in professional firms, founded my own firm, and have also had international exposure in markets like **New York, London, and Latin America.**

My expertise is in leading **mid-sized product businesses overseeing P&L, sales, pre-sales, product, operations, technology marketing and GTM.** I have had strategic and execution level leadership exposure in B2C, B2B and B2G segments across all growth stages spanning inception, expansion & growth

More fluff on LinkedIn :)



A Glimpse of 1st Innings (May 2006 till Dec 2024)

IIM CALCUTTA | **IIT DELHI** | 17 Years Experience

Position	Firm	Domain
CEO	Altrview	AR Immersive Exp
Rental Business Head	99Acres	Consumer Internet
Central Transformation Head (LatAM & UK)	Oyo	Hospitality
Founder, Director, Sab Kuch!	Reniso	Property Tech
Core Team	Rivigo	Logistics
DGM	Lanco	Energy, Infra
SY Analyst	JPMorgan Chase	Global Finance, Trading
IP Asset Manager	CPA	Intellectual Property

My Entrepreneurial Venture



2nd Innings



I am very passionate about sharing my experience and learnings across industries spanning all phases *interacting* with aspiring entrepreneurs/ students and those entering or already part of corporate set-ups

I am also passionate about ethics being encoded in buisness



Would love to engage and discuss your perspective and questions on ethics in business, marketing and everything else :)

Now let's get through a few events

Would love to get your opinions!

Scene 1

> Two coffee shops serve almost identical coffee. One struggles at ₹80. One thrives at ₹450. Why ?



Professor Alok Ki Dukaan



Sunbucks

What are customers actually paying for?



Scene 2:

A student has a bad food delivery experience once...
and permanently switches apps

Why are customers so unforgiving in services?



Scene 3:

Urban Company made people comfortable inviting strangers into their homes !

How do you design trust into a service business?



Scene 4

OYO scaled rapidly across India... and then operational inconsistency became one of its biggest challenges

Why is scaling services much harder than scaling software?



Scene 5

Two airlines fly you to the same destination. But customers emotionally trust one much more.

Why do some service brands feel dependable?



Scene 6

One bad customer complaint can become viral on social media within minutes

How do modern businesses recover trust once experience breaks?

We (together) will tackle these and various other questions in this course!

Course Learning Outcomes

By the end of the course, students should be able to demonstrate the following competencies:

1

CO1 — Principles of Services Marketing

Understand and apply the principles and characteristics of services marketing in real-world contexts.

2

CO2 — Service Strategy & Marketing Mix

Design service strategies and marketing mixes for modern service businesses across diverse sectors.

3

CO3 — Customer Behaviour & Quality

Analyse customer behaviour, service quality, and operational challenges in service delivery.

4

CO4 — Technology & Platforms

Evaluate the role of technology, platforms, AI, and digital ecosystems in contemporary services.



Pedagogy & Learning Approach

How We Learn

The course is highly participative and discussion-oriented, blending conceptual rigour with real-world application.

- Conceptual frameworks
- Real-world business examples
- Startup and platform case discussions
- Simulations and in-class activities
- Service design workshops
- Team-based projects
- Mini presentations and critiques

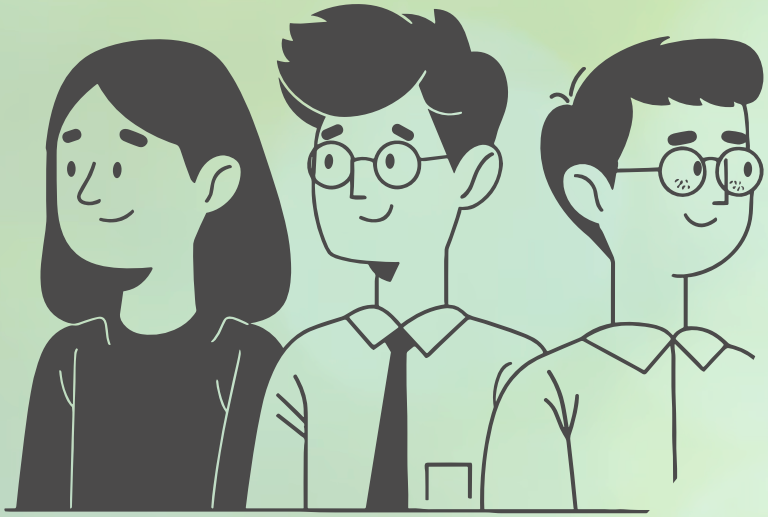


Student Mindset Expected

You are encouraged to go beyond passive consumption and engage as active thinkers and builders.

- Observe services critically in daily life
- Bring examples and observations to class
- Challenge assumptions and conventional wisdom
- Think like founders and operators
- Experiment with ideas and frameworks

Curiosity and experimentation are core to this course's spirit.



So What Exactly Is A Service

A service is an activity, experience, or performance offered by one party to another that creates value through convenience, expertise, access, support, or outcomes

Services Matter... A Lot!

From platforms like Uber, Swiggy, Airbnb, and Zomato to hospitals, banks, consulting firms, SaaS businesses, and AI-enabled digital ecosystems — service businesses dominate modern economies and shape everyday life.

Designed

Crafting experiences that meet and exceed customer expectations

Positioned

Differentiating in competitive, crowded service markets

Delivered

Executing consistently across every touchpoint

Scaled

Growing service operations without losing quality

Managed

Sustaining trust, quality, and growth over time

Multiple Lenses on Services

The course approaches services from a rich, interdisciplinary perspective — combining distinct viewpoints to build a complete picture of modern service businesses.

Marketing

Positioning, communication, and brand strategy for service firms

Customer Experience

Designing journeys that delight and retain customers

Operations

Processes, capacity, and delivery systems that work at scale

Psychology

Understanding how customers perceive, trust, and decide

Technology

AI, platforms, and digital ecosystems reshaping services

Entrepreneurship

Thinking like founders and operators, not passive consumers

Why Do You Think An Engineer Like You Should Care About Services ?

Why Engineers Should Care About Services In General?

SaaS businesses are service businesses

AI products are service ecosystems

UX/UI is service experience

Platforms coordinate services

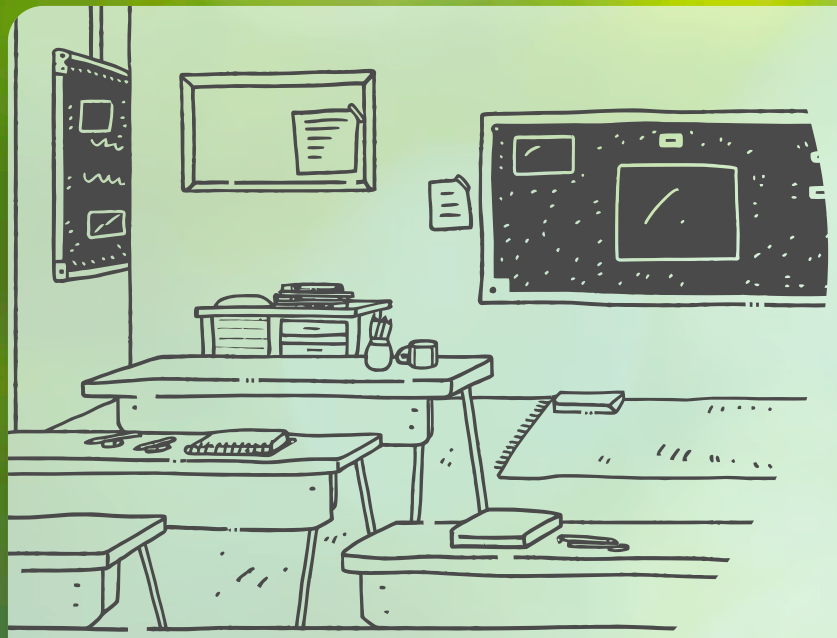
Product managers design services

Customer trust in services drives retention

Most unicorns are service-led



Every brilliant technology fails if the service experience fails.



Course Structure — Six Modules

The course is organised into six thematic modules, each building on the previous one to create a comprehensive understanding of service businesses.

Scene 1

> Two coffee shops serve almost identical coffee. One struggles at ₹80. One thrives at ₹450. Why ?



Professor Alok Ki Dukaan



Sunbucks

What are customers actually paying for?

People rarely buy only functionality anymore.

They buy convenience, trust, identity, emotion, and experience.

Our module 1 explains:

- Services,
- Experiences,
- Value perception,
- Emotional differentiation.



Module 1 — Foundations of Services & Experience Economy

What is a Service?

From goods to services to experiences: what makes services distinct

Experience Economy

Pine & Gilmore's framework and the shift to experience-led value

Challenges in Service Businesses

Managing quality, consistency, and customer expectations at scale



Scene 2:

> “A student has a bad food delivery experience once… and permanently switches apps.”

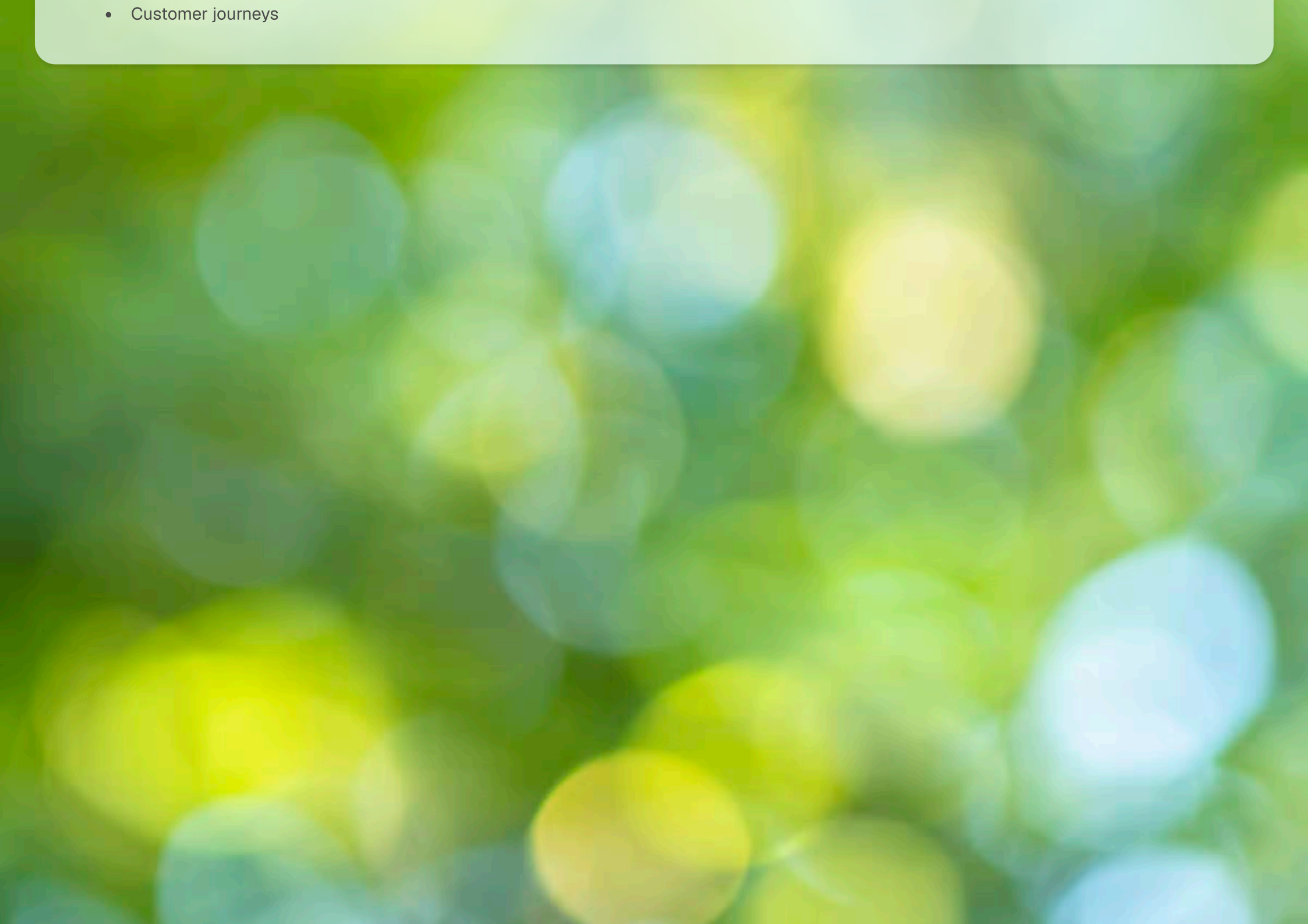
“Why are customers so unforgiving in services?”

In services, memory matters more than inventory

Module 2 explores:

- Expectations
- Trust
- Emotions
- Perceived risk

- Customer journeys



Module 2 — Consumer Behaviour & Service Encounters

Consumer Behaviour & Choice

How customers search, evaluate, and choose services, and how trust and perceived risk shape decisions

Expectations & Perceptions

The gap between what customers expect and what they actually experience

Journeys, Encounters & Moments of Truth

Mapping the end-to-end experience and the critical touchpoints that define success or failure





Urban Company made people comfortable inviting strangers into their homes !

How do you design trust into a service business?



How do you design trust into a service business?

Module 3 explains through

- Positioning
- Service design
- Blueprinting
- Branding
- Experience engineering.



Module 3 — Service Strategy & Service Design

Strategy, Positioning & Differentiation

Defining where and how to compete, identifying target segments, and building meaningful differentiation

Service Innovation & Blueprinting

Creating new service concepts and visualising the delivery process end-to-end

Branding & Experience Design

Building trust and identity when the product is intangible, and crafting every sensory and emotional dimension of the encounter



OYO scaled rapidly across India... and then operational inconsistency became one of its biggest challenges

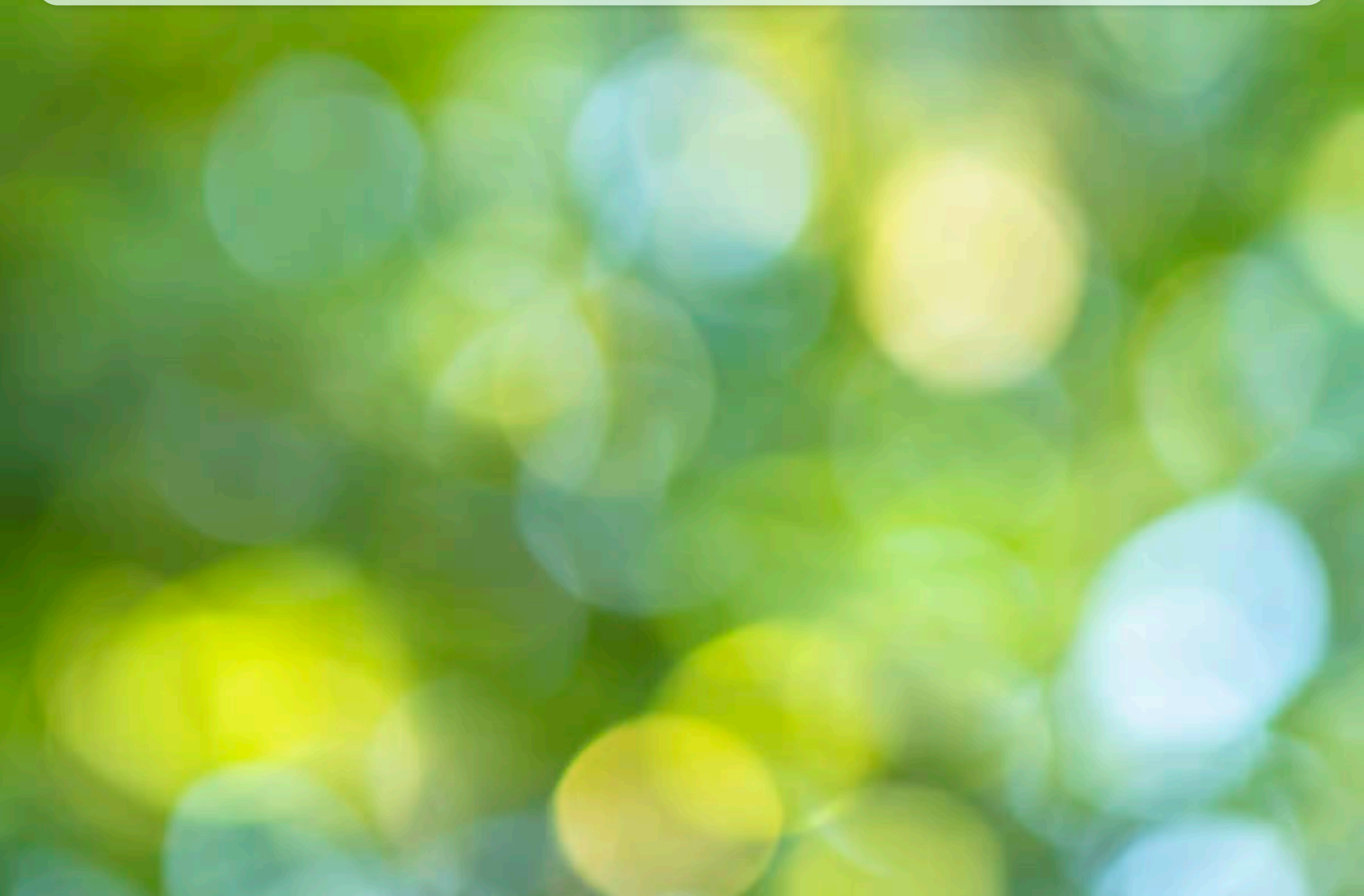
Why is scaling services much harder than scaling software?

In services, operations IS marketing !

Module 4 explains:

- Processes,
- Standardization,
- Capacity,
- Delivery systems,

- Pricing logic.



Module 4 — Service Delivery, Operations & Pricing

Operational excellence is the backbone of great service. This module explores how services are delivered, managed, and priced for sustainable profitability.

Delivery Channels & Service Processes

Physical, digital, and hybrid channels for reaching customers, balancing consistency with personalisation

Capacity & Demand Management

Managing the perishability challenge — matching supply with fluctuating demand

Pricing, Yield & Dynamic Strategies

Value-based, cost-based, and dynamic pricing for sustainable profitability — airlines, hotels, ride-hailing





Scene 5

Two airlines fly you to the same destination. But customers emotionally trust one much more.

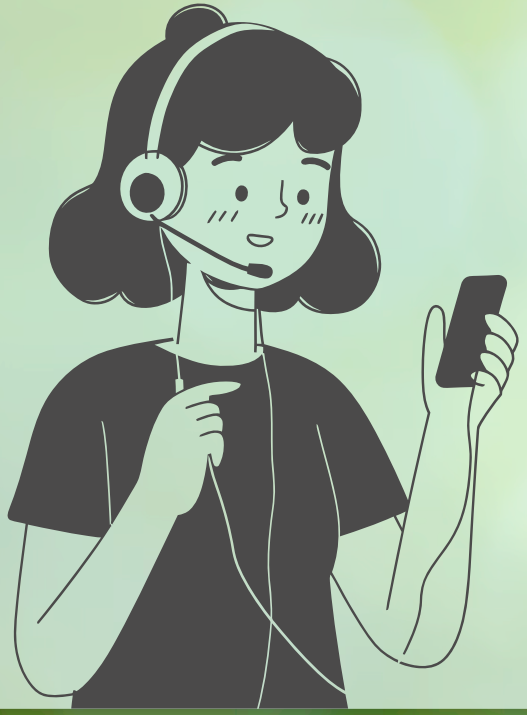
Why do some service brands feel dependable?



Why do some service brands feel dependable?

Module 5 explores:

- Communication,
- Servicescape
- Employees,
- Trust Signals
- Customer Participation.



Module 5 — Communication, People & Experience

Communication & Digital Trust

Making the intangible tangible, building credibility, and managing reputation through digital channels and online reviews

People, Servicescape & Co-creation

Empowered employees, engaged customers, and the physical environment shape the service experience together



One bad customer complaint can become viral on social media within minutes

How do modern businesses recover trust once experience breaks?



Technology can automate processes.

But trust still needs to be designed!

Module 6 explains:

- Service Recovery,
- Complaint Handling,
- Ai-Enabled Services,
- Future Ecosystems.



Module 6 — Quality, Recovery & the Future of Services

Quality & Recovery

Measuring and improving service quality, and turning failures into loyalty-building opportunities

Technology & AI

How digital tools, algorithmic services, and platform businesses are transforming service delivery

Ethics & Future of Services

Responsibility, fairness, and sustainability in the evolving service economy

Course Structure — Six Modules Summary

1

Module 1

Foundations of Services & Experience Economy

2

Module 2

Consumer Behaviour & Service Encounters

3

Module 3

Service Strategy & Service Design

4

Module 4

Delivery, Operations & Pricing

5

Module 5

Communication, People & Experience

6

Module 6

Quality, Recovery & Future of Services

Industries & Organisations We'll Explore

The course draws on examples from a wide range of sectors and illustrative organisations that have redefined service in their respective domains.



Food & Mobility

Swiggy, Zomato, Uber — redefining on-demand service delivery



Hospitality & Travel

Airbnb, OYO, IndiGo — disrupting traditional hospitality and aviation



Healthcare

Apollo Hospitals, Practo — technology-enabled healthcare services



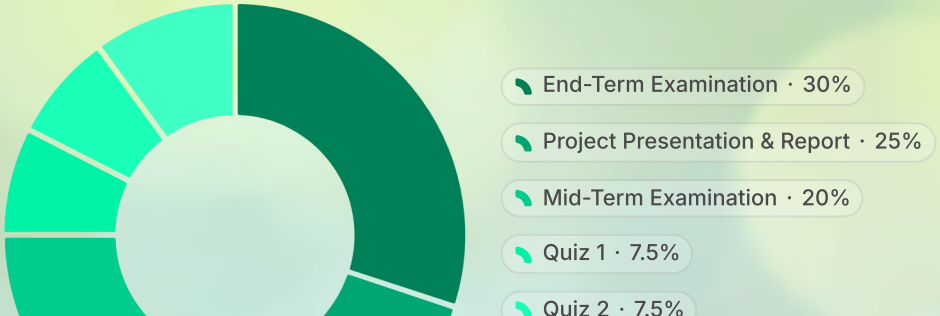
Entertainment & Retail

Netflix, Amazon, Apple — subscription and platform-driven service models

Other sectors include FinTech, EdTech, SaaS, Real Estate Platforms, E-commerce, and AI-enabled Services.

Assessment Structure

The course uses a balanced assessment approach that rewards consistent engagement, analytical thinking, and applied project work throughout the term.



Breakdown at a Glance

Component	Weightage
Class Participation & Discussions	10%
Quiz 1	7.5%



Quiz 2	7.5%
Mid-Term Examination	20%
End-Term Examination	30%
Project Presentation & Final Report	25%

Nature of Assessments

Quizzes

- Apply frameworks to real scenarios, not recall definitions.

Mid-Term & End-Term Examinations

- Applied concepts, mini cases, and strategic thinking. Depth of reasoning over breadth.

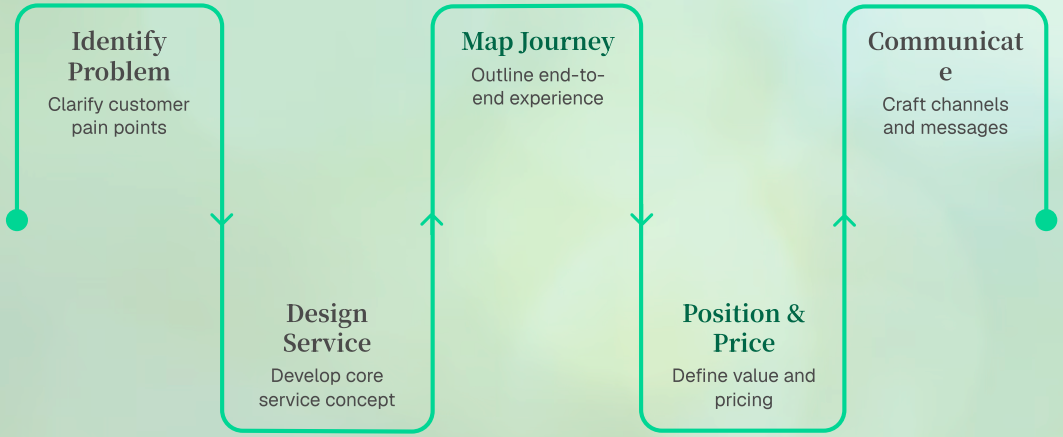
Team Project

- Conceptualise a scalable service venture covering design, journey, pricing, communication, and delivery.



The Team Project

The project is the centrepiece of the course — a term-long exercise in building a real, scalable service venture from the ground up.



Teams will work consistently throughout the term, applying each module's frameworks directly to their venture — making the project a living laboratory for course concepts.



Who Should Take This Course?

Product Management

Design and iterate on service products with a customer-first lens

Consulting & Strategy

Diagnose service challenges and recommend strategic solutions

Entrepreneurship & Startups

Build scalable service ventures from concept to delivery

Customer Experience

Design journeys that build loyalty and advocacy

Platform & AI Businesses

Understand network effects, digital ecosystems, and AI-driven services

Operations & Brand Building

Manage delivery systems and build trusted service brands

Recommended Reading

Core Texts

1. **Lovelock & Wirtz**

   Services Marketing — the definitive textbook on the discipline

2. **Zeithaml, Bitner & Gremler**

Supplementary Reading

Pine & Gilmore

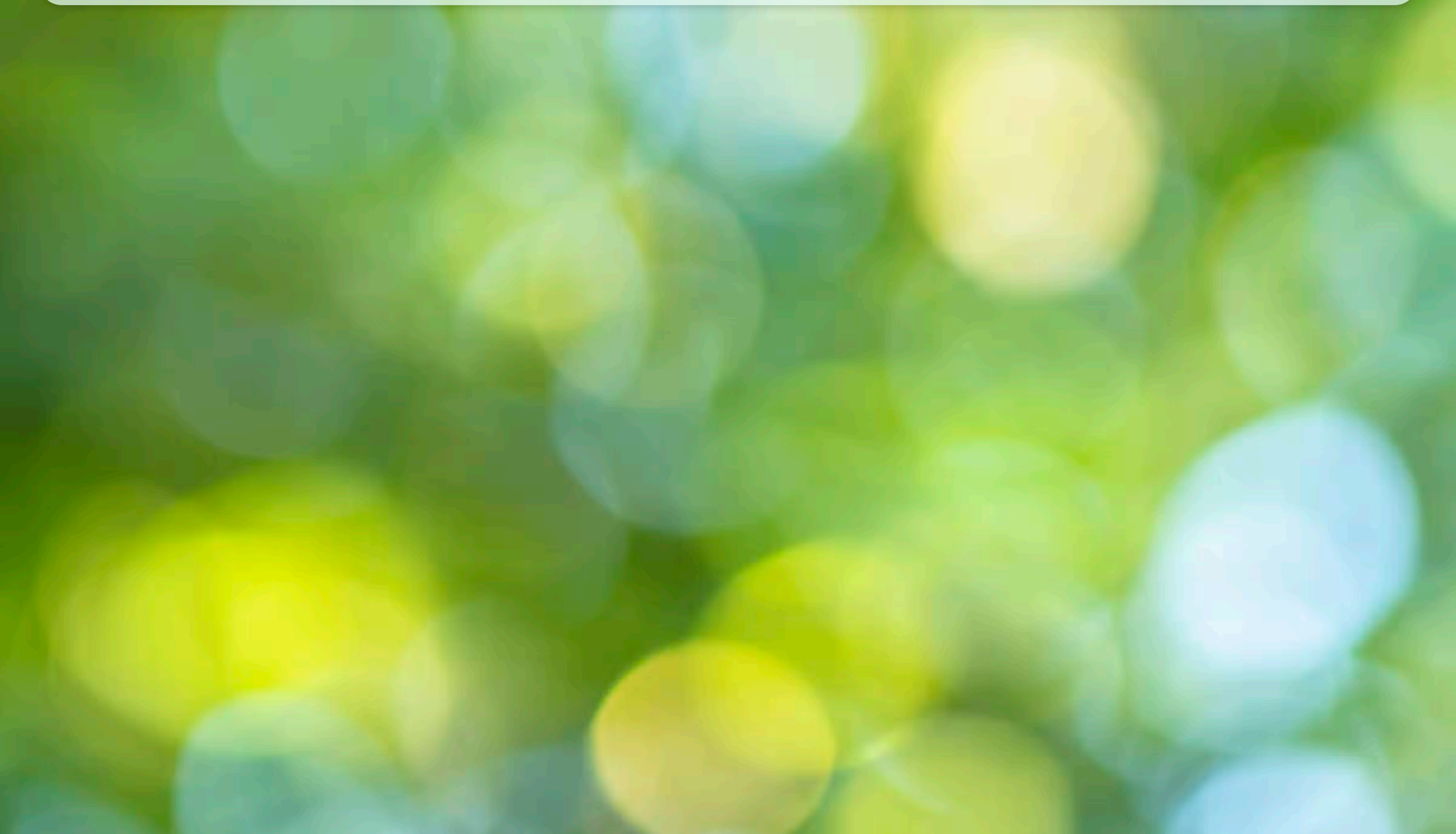
The Experience Economy — the foundational text on experience as economic offering

Cases, Articles & Videos

Selected materials shared during the course to ground frameworks in real-world contexts

Services Marketing: Integrating Customer Focus Across the Firm

- Reading is not optional — it is the foundation for meaningful class participation and analytical depth.





Closing Thought

> In the modern economy, every business is increasingly becoming a service business.

Organisations that understand customer experience, trust, operational excellence, and scalable service delivery will define the future. This course is designed to help students think deeply about building such organisations.

Experience

Design moments that matter

Trust

Build relationships that last

Scale

Grow without losing quality

Future

Lead the service economy

☆ ENT307 — IIIT DELHI — SUMMER TERM